

A Southern senator once declared: "No, you dare not to make war on cotton. No power on the earth dares to make war upon it. Cotton is King." He was to be proved wrong.

“ The Army ... has been
compelled to yield to
overwhelming numbers and
resources.”

ROBERT E. LEE, FAREWELL ADDRESS TO THE ARMY OF NORTHERN
VIRGINIA, 1865

Underlying weakness

Despite the Confederacy's important advantages, the more advanced state of industrialization in the North, its larger supply of natural resources such as iron and coal, and its greater economic strength, enabled it to sustain war for longer than the South could. And, unlike Britain during the American Revolution and the War of 1812, the North did not have to cross an ocean to bring its military power to bear.